

I want to know in detail How a Bill Becomes a Law: Tracking a piece of legislation from its first reading to the presidential signature.

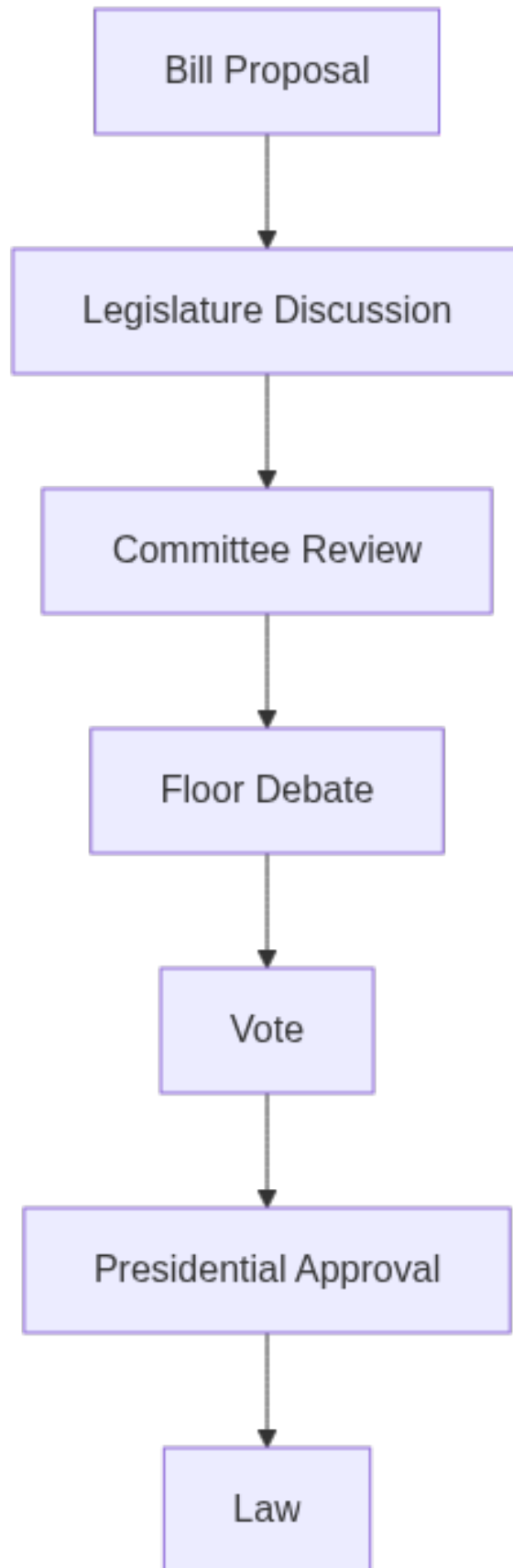
A Visual Research Report

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1. Overview of the Legislative Process

A bill is a proposal for a new law or a substantial alteration of an existing law. It must be passed by the legislature and approved by the head of state to become law. The legislative process involves several stages, including drafting, committee scrutiny, floor debates, and actions by both chambers of Congress and the President.

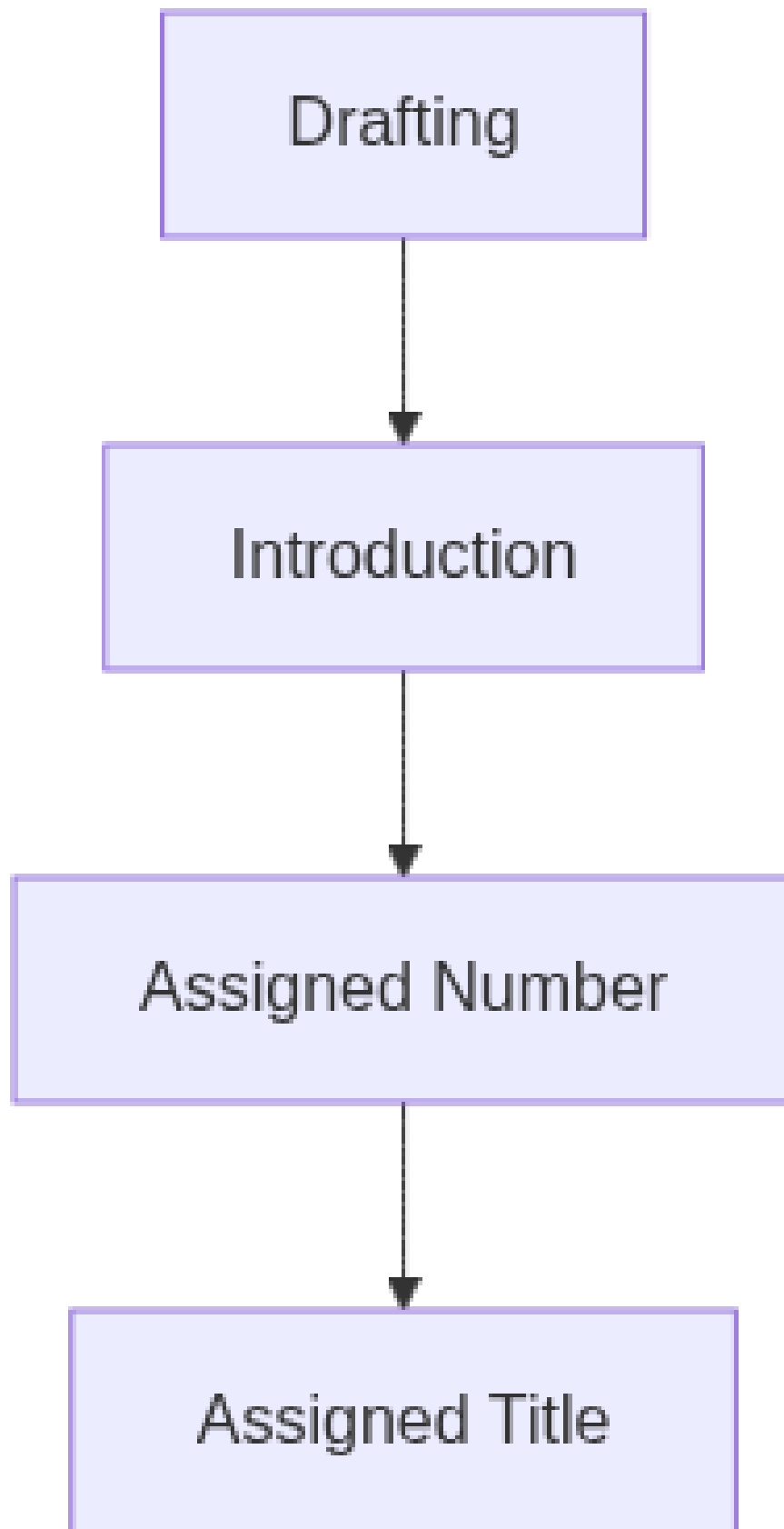
Overview of the Legislative Process



2. Step 1: Drafting and Introduction

The legislative process begins with the drafting of a bill. This can be done by a member of Congress or by a group of legislators. Once drafted, the bill is introduced in either the House of Representatives or the Senate, where it is assigned a number and title.

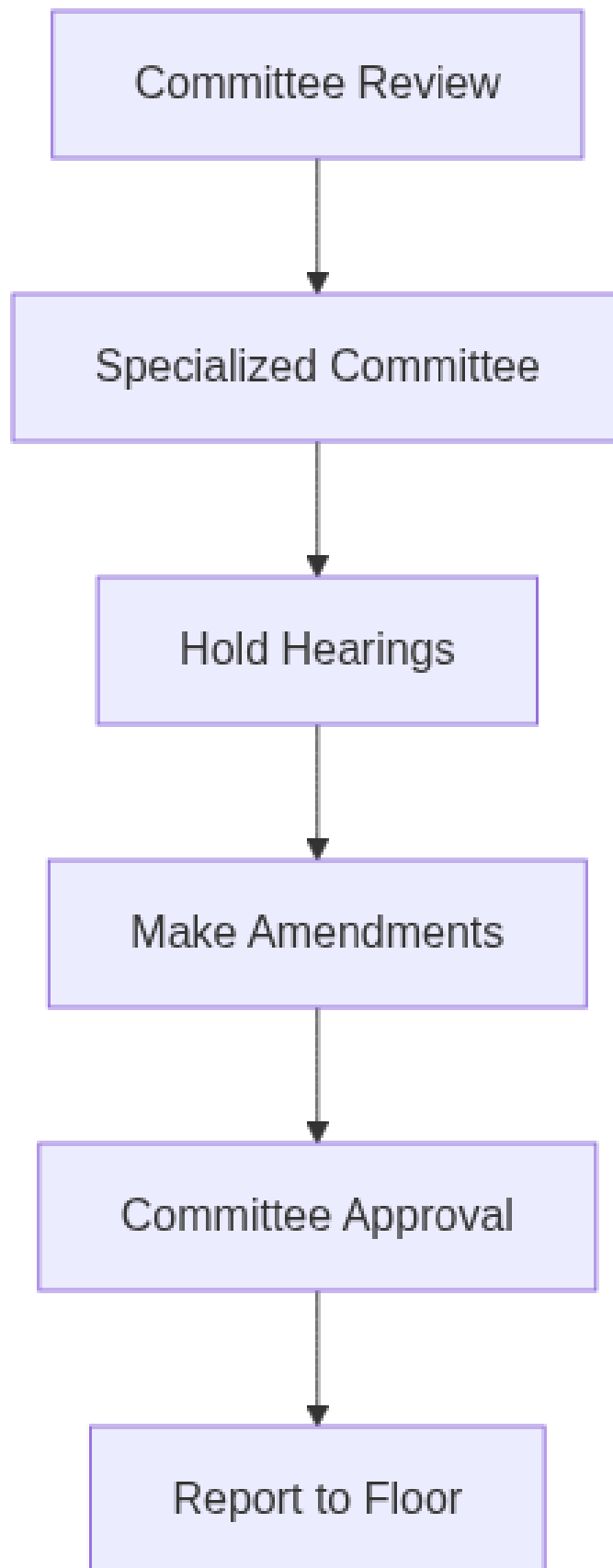
Step 1: Drafting and Introduction



3. Step 2: Committee Review

After introduction, the bill is sent to a committee that specializes in the bill's subject matter. The committee reviews the bill, holds hearings, and may make amendments. If the committee approves the bill, it is reported out to the floor for further consideration.

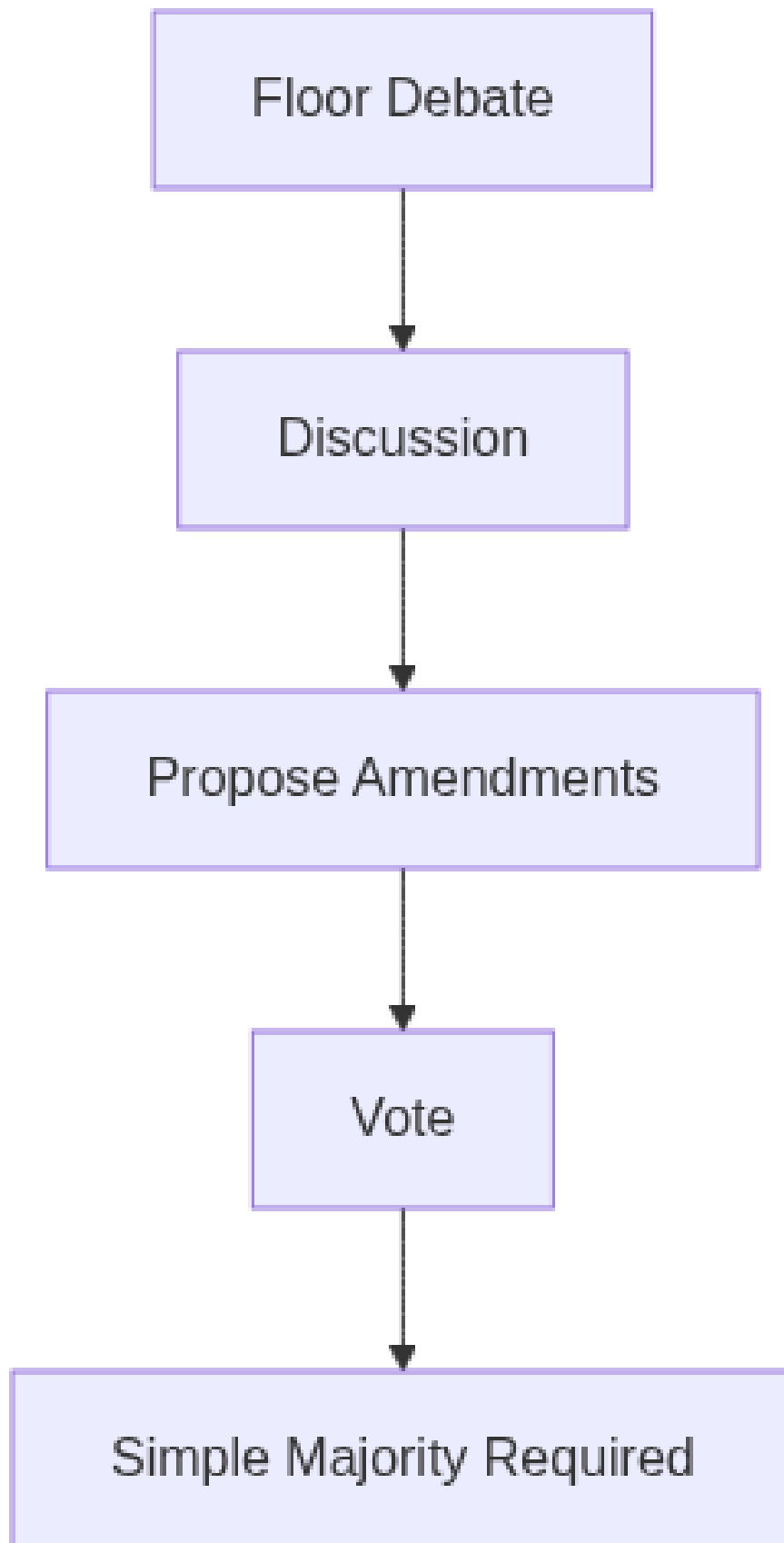
Step 2: Committee Review



4. Step 3: Floor Debate and Voting

Once reported out of committee, the bill is debated on the floor of the House or Senate. Members can discuss the bill, propose further amendments, and ultimately vote on it. A simple majority is required for the bill to pass.

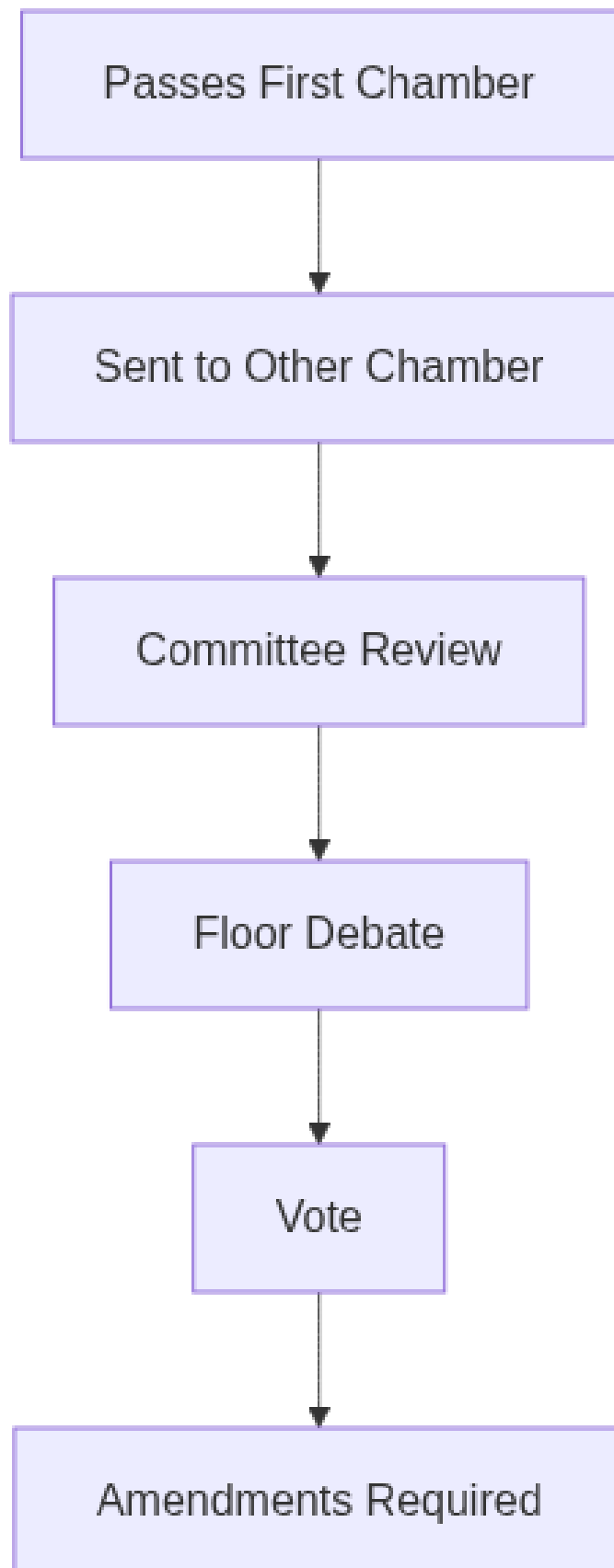
Step 3: Floor Debate and Voting



5. Step 4: Consideration by the Other Chamber

If the bill passes in one chamber, it is sent to the other chamber (House or Senate) for consideration. The second chamber may repeat the process of committee review, floor debate, and voting. If the second chamber makes amendments, the bill must return to the first chamber for approval.

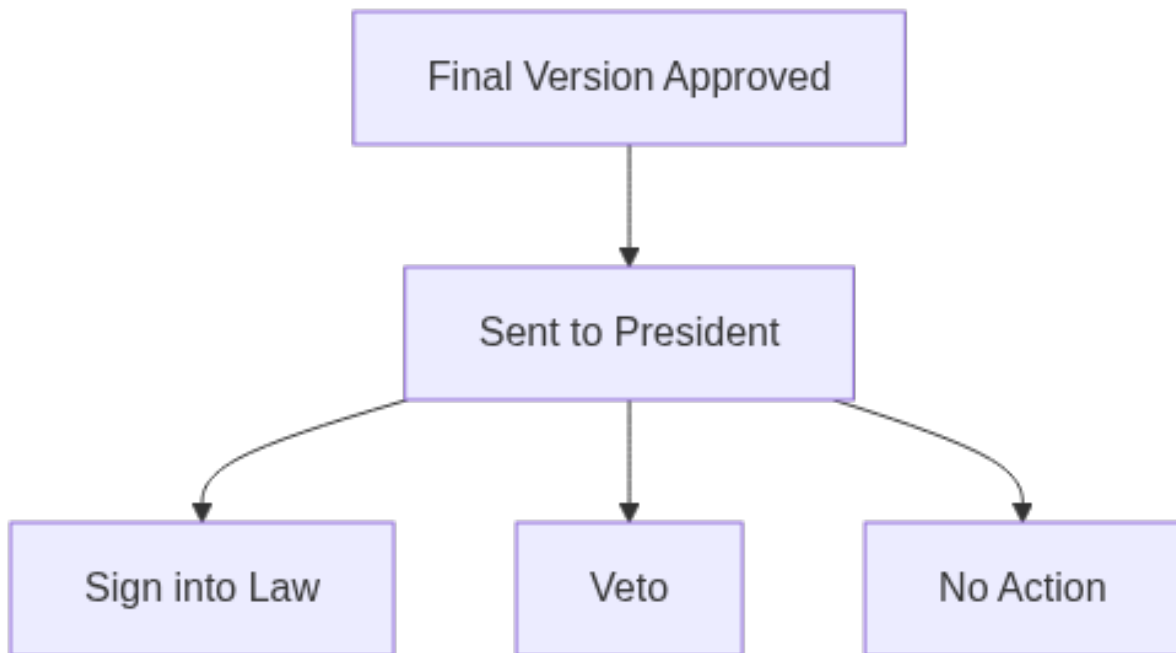
Step 4: Consideration by the Other Chamber



6. Step 5: Presidential Action

Once both chambers have agreed on the final version of the bill, it is sent to the President. The President can either sign the bill into law, veto it, or take no action (which can result in the bill becoming law after a certain period if Congress is in session).

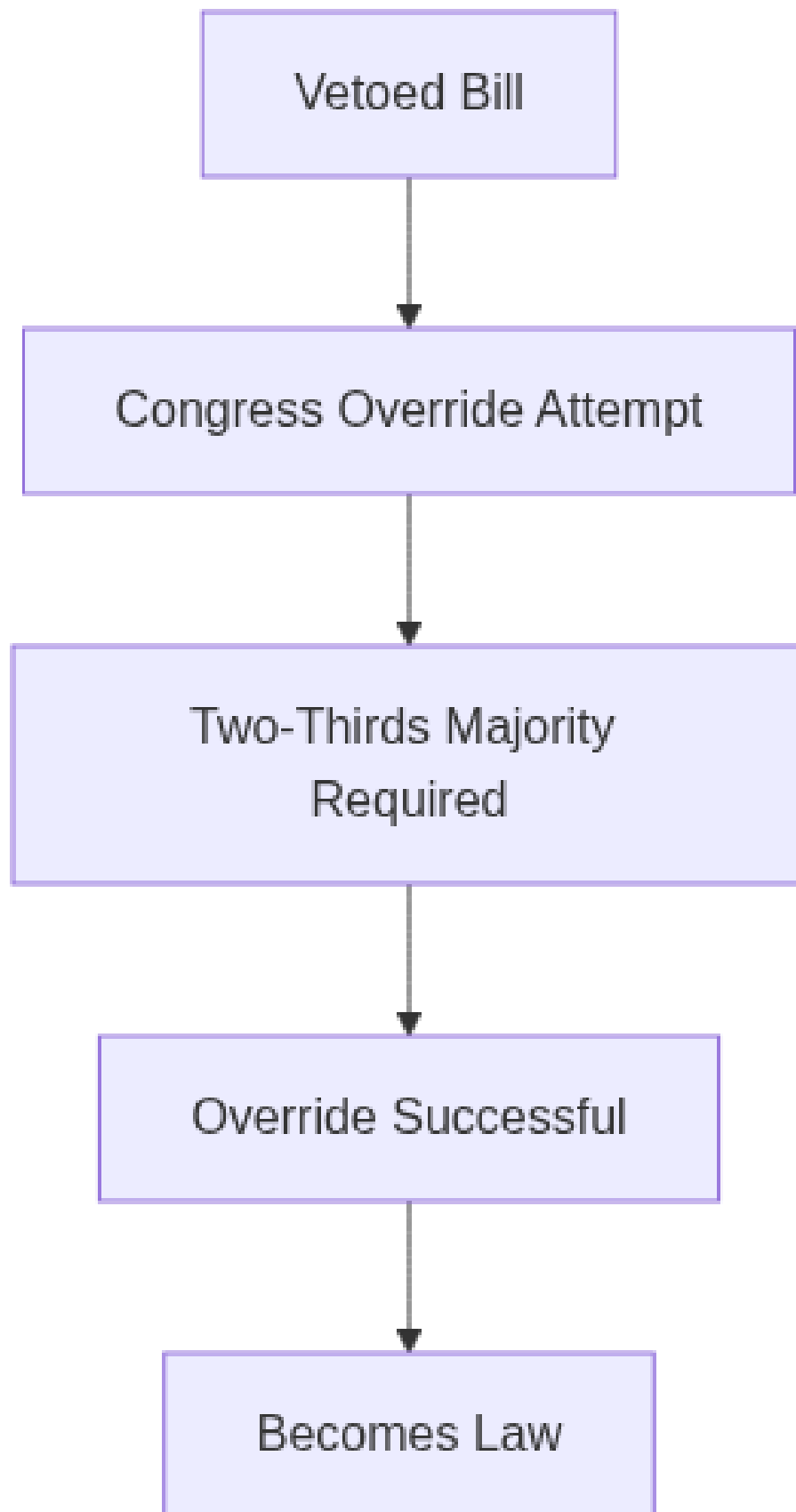
Step 5: Presidential Action



7. Step 6: Veto Override (if applicable)

If the President vetoes the bill, Congress can attempt to override the veto. This requires a two-thirds majority vote in both chambers. If successful, the bill becomes law despite the President's veto.

Step 6: Veto Override (if applicable)



8. Final Summary of the Legislative Process

The process of how a bill becomes a law involves several key steps: drafting and introduction, committee review, floor debate and voting, consideration by the other chamber, presidential action, and potential veto override. Each step is crucial in ensuring thorough examination and debate of proposed legislation.